

Using Microsoft WebMatrix

1. Download and install Microsoft WebMatrix from <http://www.microsoft.com/web/gallery/install.aspx?appid=webmatrix> on your system. It will automatically install the other additional components like IIS and Microsoft SQL Server Express.
2. Once installed, you can just open Microsoft WebMatrix and click on 'Site from Web Gallery' to select WordPress for installation.



Note: With WebMatrix 3, just after installation, you will have to select *New->App Gallery* to open the option 'Site from Web Gallery'.

3. As prerequisites, along with WordPress, it also downloads and installs MySQL and PHP packages automatically.
4. WordPress needs a database to be installed for data management. So you can create a new database using the MySQL database that was downloaded and installed.
5. During the process, you might have to set the credentials for accessing the database that will be used by WordPress.
6. Once the WordPress installation is complete, open the WebMatrix site workspace to launch your WordPress site by clicking on the 'Run' button. This page gives you the URL or permalink of your site.
7. Here you can also access the source PHP pages for your site from the files workspace. You can modify the pages as per your requirement and once you have modified them, you will have to click on 'Run again' from WebMatrix to launch your site.
8. Your site has now been launched using the default Web browser (e.g., Internet Explorer).
9. Now log in to your site using the required credentials and access the WordPress dashboard to modify your site. For detailed steps on how to use the WordPress dashboard, visit Reference 6 below.

For a detailed step by step guide refer to <http://www.microsoft.com/web/post/your-first-website-using-webmatrix>.

Using Microsoft's Web Platform Installer (Web PI)

1. Download and install Microsoft's Web Platform Installer from <http://www.microsoft.com/web/downloads/platform.aspx> on your system.
2. Under the 'Applications' category in the Web PI, you can add a set of open source applications to install them in your system. Add 'WordPress' to install it on your system.
3. The Web PI also downloads and installs MySQL and PHP packages along with WordPress.
4. As mentioned above, you will need to create a new database that can be used by WordPress to store its contents.
5. Now you can open an Internet Explorer page and access your WordPress dashboard by opening your site as <http://localhost/<your site name>>.

6. At this page, provide the required information to complete the WordPress installation.
7. Now you can log in to your site using the required credentials and access the WordPress dashboard to modify your site. For detailed steps on using the WordPress dashboard, visit http://codex.wordpress.org/Administration_Screens (see References at the end of the article).
For a detailed step by step guide, refer to http://codex.wordpress.org/Installing_on_Microsoft_IIS.

Once you have created, modified and published your site using WordPress, it can be accessed using your system's hostname or IP address.

Tips and best practices

You can create either a self-hosted site or a free site at WordPress.com. While a self-hosted site may require some initial investment and maintenance costs, a free site may not be best suited for all your requirements as the URL for the site will be something like *yoursitenamewordpress.com*. So depending on the purpose of your site and your budget, make your choice.

Make a habit of updating your WordPress version, as well as your site, to avoid any security vulnerability. But make sure you have proper backup for your site. For WordPress backup options, refer to http://codex.wordpress.org/WordPress_Backups.

Windows Live writer is another free tool from Microsoft, which can be integrated with WordPress to easily modify your WordPress site's contents and to add pictures or videos. You can download it from <http://www.microsoft.com/en-in/download/details.aspx?id=8621>.

For a comprehensive list of WordPress best practices, do refer to <http://vip.wordpress.com/documentation/best-practices/>. 

References

- [1] http://codex.wordpress.org/First_Steps_With_WordPress
- [2] http://codex.wordpress.org/Working_with_WordPress
- [3] <http://easypguide.com/>
- [4] <http://www.iis.net/>
- [5] <http://www.microsoft.com/web/downloads/>
- [6] http://codex.wordpress.org/Administration_Screens

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